and painted it with a backdrop of the bird's natural habitat. Between 1827 and 1838 he published *The Birds of America* in a series of installments. It included 435 colored prints of 497 species, six of which are now extinct. Audubon also discovered 25 previously undescribed species and used yarn to "band" birds—meaning he tied it to their legs, allowing him to identify individual bird—to find out more about their movements.

See also: Animal ecology

MARY ANNING

1799–1847

In 2010, the Royal Society named Anning as one of the 10 British women who have most influenced the history of science. She found fame as a fossil collector and paleontologist, and her extraordinary fossil finds, from Jurassic strata in the cliffs of the Dorset coast, included the first correctly described ichthyosaur, two relatively complete plesiosaurs, and the first pterosaur from outside Germany. Her finds helped change views about Earth's history, providing strong evidence for extinction.

See also: Mass extinctions

CATHERINE PARR TRAILL

1802–1899

A botanist and prolific author, Traill was born in the UK and emigrated to what is now Ontario, Canada, after she married in 1832. There, she wrote about life as a settler in Canada. She also wrote about the natural environment, notably in *Canadian Wild Flowers* (1868) and *Studies of Plant Life in Canada* (1885). Her many albums of plant collections are housed in the National Herbarium of Canada, at the Canadian Museum of Nature in Ottawa.

See also: Endangered habitats